

I actually think this is one of the most important parts of Wahala. What you're building isn't just a CRM or a project management tool—you're building a software engineering delivery platform. Your partner sees the world beginning at "requirements." In reality, engineering starts much earlier.

I'd explain it like this.

The Wahala Delivery Pipeline

The Philosophy

Most software projects fail because engineering starts with solutions instead of understanding the business.

By the time a developer receives requirements, dozens of decisions have already been made—often informally in meetings, emails, and phone calls. Those decisions are rarely documented, which leads to scope creep, misunderstandings, and expensive rewrites.

Wahala captures that knowledge as it is created and progressively transforms it into engineering artifacts.

Think of it like a manufacturing assembly line.

Business Problem



Discovery



Solution Design



Proposal



Contract



Project Planning



Engineering



Testing



Deployment

Each phase has a different audience, a different purpose, and a different output.

Phase 1 — Sales Discovery

Purpose

Understand the customer's business before discussing technology.

This phase is about learning.

Not selling.

Not designing.

Not estimating.

Simply understanding.

Today, this usually happens through one or more discovery meetings.
Sales asks questions.
The customer explains how they operate.
Notes are taken.
Whiteboards get filled.
Ideas get discussed.
Most of this knowledge is lost after the meeting.

Inputs

Lead

Initial customer meeting

Customer contacts Wahala

Activities

Learn the business

Understand the current workflow

Identify pain points

Understand goals

Determine stakeholders

Identify budget

Identify timeline

Document terminology

Deliverables

Business Profile

Current Workflow

Business Goals

Pain Points

Success Metrics

Decision Makers

Initial Opportunity

Why this matters

Engineering cannot build a solution without understanding the problem.

A customer asking for “a dashboard” is not a requirement.

The requirement is why they believe they need a dashboard.

Transfer to Phase 2

Once Wahala understands the business, Discovery is complete.

Everything collected becomes the input to Solution Design.

Phase 2 — Solution Design

Purpose

Transform business problems into a proposed solution.

Sales stops thinking like a consultant.
Now we become solution architects.
Today this usually happens internally.
The customer may not even attend.
Engineering, product, and sales collaborate.

Inputs

Discovery Package
Business Workflow
Goals
Pain Points
Budget
Timeline

Activities

Analyze workflows
Remove unnecessary steps
Identify automation opportunities
Determine integrations
High-level architecture
Estimate complexity
Determine risks

Deliverables

Future Workflow
High-Level Architecture
Integration List
Project Scope
Assumptions
Risks
Initial Estimate

Why this matters

Customers don't buy software.
They buy a better way of doing business.
This phase defines that better way.

Transfer

The approved solution becomes the basis of the proposal.

Phase 3 — Proposal

Purpose

Convert the proposed solution into a commercial offering.
Today this is often done in Word.

Or PowerPoint.

Or PDFs.

The proposal explains

What we will build

Why it solves the problem

How much it costs

How long it takes

Inputs

Solution Design

Estimate

Architecture

Timeline

Activities

Generate pricing

Build implementation phases

Generate options

Define assumptions

Prepare executive summary

Deliverables

Proposal

Pricing

Timeline

Scope

Commercial Options

Example

Option A

Custom software.

Customer owns everything.

Higher initial investment.

Option B

Built on Wahala Gateway.

Lower cost.

Recurring platform subscription.

Why this matters

The proposal aligns business expectations before engineering begins.

Transfer

Customer approves proposal.

Moves into contracting.

Phase 4 — Contract

Purpose

Turn an agreement into an executable project.

Today

Lawyers

Signatures

Deposits

Insurance

NDA

MSA

SOW

Inputs

Proposal

Pricing

Customer Information

Activities

Finalize legal documents

Collect signatures

Collect deposit

Create customer account

Deliverables

Executed Contract

Signed SOW

Payment

Project Authorization

Why this matters

Engineering should never start without commercial approval.

Transfer

Signed contract automatically creates a project.

Phase 5 — Project Planning

Purpose

Convert the signed agreement into an engineering plan.

This is where developers typically believe projects begin.

In reality, this is only the midpoint.

Inputs

Contract
Proposal
Discovery
Solution Design

Activities
Break work into Epics
Generate Stories
Acceptance Criteria
Database Design
Architecture
Sprint Planning
Resource Planning
Risk Review

Deliverables
Backlog
Epics
Stories
Architecture
Roadmap
Sprint Plan

Why this matters
Engineering now has enough context to build the right thing.

Transfer
Sprint One begins.

Phase 6 — Engineering
Purpose
Build the solution.
Inputs
Stories
Designs
Architecture
Acceptance Criteria
Outputs
Working Software

Transfer
Features move to QA.

Phase 7 — Quality Assurance

Purpose

Verify that the software solves the business problem.

Not just that it passes tests.

Outputs

Approved Release

Bug Reports

Customer Validation

Transfer

Release Candidate

Phase 8 — Deployment

Purpose

Deliver value.

Activities

Deploy

Train

Onboard

Monitor

Support

Collect feedback

Transfer

Customer Success

Future Enhancements

The Information Flow

This is the concept I would emphasize to your partner.

Lead

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Discovery

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"Understand the business."



Business Requirements

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Solution Design

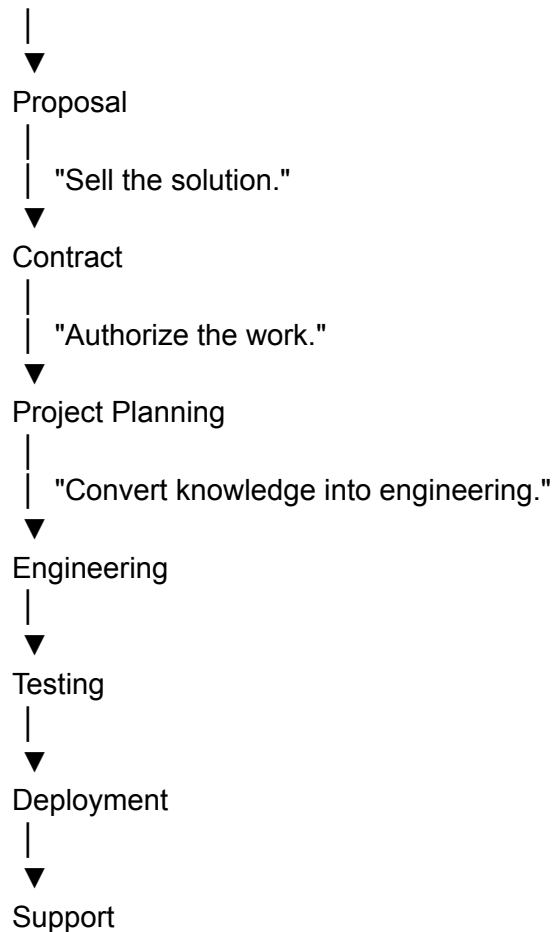
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"Design the workflow."



Proposed Solution



Why this matters to a developer

The biggest mindset shift is that each phase reduces uncertainty.

At the start of Discovery, uncertainty is at its highest: you don't yet know the customer's real problem, constraints, budget, or goals. Every subsequent phase transforms that uncertainty into increasingly concrete artifacts:

- Discovery reduces business uncertainty by documenting problems, goals, and workflows..
- Solution Design reduces technical uncertainty by proposing an approach and identifying risks..
- Proposal and Contract reduce commercial uncertainty by aligning scope, cost, ownership, and expectations..
- Project Planning reduces execution uncertainty by turning the agreed solution into epics, stories, and implementation plans..
- Engineering reduces product uncertainty by producing working software..
- QA and Deployment reduce operational uncertainty by verifying the solution works in the customer's environment and delivers the intended business value..

From an engineering perspective, Wahala isn't just tracking a sales pipeline—it's preserving the context that is normally lost between sales, product, and development. Instead of handing developers a list of stories with no history, it hands them a complete chain of reasoning from the customer's original business problem to the code they're writing. That traceability is what

enables better estimates, fewer misunderstandings, less rework, and ultimately a higher likelihood of delivering software that solves the customer's actual problem.